

2.1 Imaginative writing

Paper 2 Writing · 2026 examination · Concept guide and original exam-style practice

Understand the concept

Narrative and descriptive writing require deliberate perspective, setting and structural movement. Description can develop a mood through selected senses without becoming a list; narrative needs a change or tension. Sentence length and focalisation control pace. Draft one governing idea and revise away redundant modifiers.

Worked example: follow the reasoning

To describe a station after the last train, begin with a lit departure board, narrow to a single abandoned glove, then end with lights switching off; the sequence produces change without an elaborate plot.

Original practice stimulus

Writing brief: The first sentence is “The lights went out one floor at a time.” Your setting is a public building after closing time. A single character is still inside. You may write a narrative scene or a descriptive piece, but show a clear change between the opening and ending. Avoid explaining everything that the character thinks: choose physical details that allow a reader to infer uncertainty. You can use a lift, stairwell or street outside if useful; none is required. Aim for a sustained voice and a purposeful final image. After writing, identify two deliberate decisions about pacing, viewpoint or imagery.

Extended response

Compose your response in the space provided and support your interpretation with evidence.

1 Write 200–250 words beginning “The lights went out one floor at a time.” Create a distinct atmosphere and explain two structural choices. [25]

Check: relevant evidence · coherent argument · accurate and deliberate language

Answers and explanation

Question 1 [25 marks]

Credit coherent perspective, sustained atmosphere, crafted sensory imagery and purposeful ending. An effective commentary explains why gradual darkening is repeated for pacing and why the final image changes the reader's interpretation, with quoted phrases from the student's own draft.

Self-assessment

Compare each credited step with your own answer. Fix the first reasoning or calculation error; then retry without looking at the solution.

Syllabus: English Language 9093, 2024–2026.

<https://www.cambridgeinternational.org/Images/635901-2024-2026-syllabus.pdf>

Original FagusED teaching material. Question layout and mark presentation informed by the May/June 2026 papers supplied by the user. The practice question is newly written and is not a Cambridge past-paper question.